



Laptops							Workhorses above Rs 40,000					
Brand Model	HCL G28 CP	HCL P28 PDC	Intex M722S	HCL B30 C2D	HCL Z24 C2D	Acer Aspire 5920		LG Xnote R405	Fujitsu S7211	Acer Aspire 2920	Dell Inspiron 1525	ASUS F5SL
Price	Rs 22,490	Rs 28,990	Rs 30,900	Rs 32,990	Rs 38,490	Rs 39,139		Rs 40,000	Rs 41,000	Rs 41,199	Rs 42,900	Rs 44,990
Plus (+)	Inexpensive	Inexpensive	Compact	Solid Build	Solid Build	Cute		Well built	Slim, well built	Plasticity	Well built	Good specs
Minus (-)	Clunky	Clunky	Build quality	Clunky	None in particular	Plasticity		Bulky	None in particular	Bulky	Plain looking	Bulky
Grand Total (Out of 100)	47.19	51.71	58.75	61.50	61.00	64.12		60.22	67.41	60.13	69.06	70.95
Features (Out of 55)	26.22	30.62	39.25	38.60	37.50	40.89		34.17	40.12	37.66	42.38	40.63
Performance (Out of 45)	20.97	21.09	19.50	22.90	23.50	23.75		26.05	27.28	22.47	26.68	30.32
Features												
Component Specifications												
Processor / Clock Speed	T2310 / 1.73 GHz	T2330 / 1.6 GHz	T2450 / 2.0 GHz	T5550 / 1.83 GHz	T5550 / 1.83 GHz	T5550 / 1.83 GHz		T5550 / 1.83 GHz	T7500 / 2.2 GHz	T5550 / 1.83 GHz	T7250 / 2.0 GHz	T5550 /1.83 GHz
RAM / Type / Clock Speed	1024 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	1024 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz		1024 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	1024 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz	2048 MB / DDR2 / 667 MHz
Chipset	P4M 900	P4M 900	SiS 671	SiS 671	GM965	GM965		Radeon Xpress 1100	GM965	GM965	GM965	SiS 671FX
Graphics Solution / Onboard Memory (MB)	Via Chrome 9 / Shared	Via Chrome 9 / Shared	SiS Mirage / Shared	SiS Mirage 3 / 128 MB	X3100 / Shared	X3100 / Shared		Radeon Xpress 1250 / 128 MB	X3100 / Shared	X3100 / Shared	X3100 / Shared	Radeon HD3470 / 256 MB
HDD Size (GB)	80 GB	160 GB	160 GB	80 GB	160 GB	160 GB		160 GB	160 GB	160 GB	160 GB	160 GB
Bundled OS	Free DOS	Free DOS	NA	Free DOS	Vista Home Premium	Linux		Vista Basic	Vista Basic	Linux	Vista Home Premium	Vista Home Premium
Characteristics												
Screen Size (Inches)	15.4 inches	15.4 inches	12.1 inches	15.4 inches	14.1 inches	15.4 inches		14.1 inches	14.1 inches	12.1 inches	15.4 inches	15.4 inches
Screen Resolution (Native)	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels		1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels	1280 x 800 pixels
Weight (kg)	3 kgs	2.92 kgs	2.2 kgs	3.05 kgs	2.3 kgs	3.0 kgs		2.3 kgs	2.2 kgs	2.04 kgs	2.6 kgs	2.6 kgs
No of Ports (USB / FireWire)	4 / 0	4 / 0	3 / 1	4 / 1	4 / 0	4 / 1		3 / 0	3 / 0	3 / 0	4 / 1	4 / 0
Connectivity (LAN / Bluetooth / WiFi)	✓ / ✗ / ✓	✓ / ✗ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✗ / ✓	✓ / ✗ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓		✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓ / ✓
Memory Card Reader (Y / N)	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Inbuilt Webcam (Y / N)	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Media Centre Remote (Y / N)	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗		✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Build (So 10)												
Build Quality (Body / Keypad / Lid, movables)	7.25 / 7 / 7	7.25 / 7 / 7	6.5 / 6.5 / 6.5	7.25 / 7 / 7	7.25 / 7 / 7	5.25 / 5.5 / 5.5		7.25 / 7 / 7	7.5 / 7.25 / 7	5.25 / 5.5 / 5.5	6.5 / 6.75 / 6.5	6.5 / 7 / 7
Ergonomics												
Keypad Tactility / Layout / Shortcuts (So 10)	6.75 / 5 / 4.5	6.75 / 5 / 4.5	7 / 6.5 / 6	6.75 / 5 / 5.5	6.75 / 5.5 / 4.5	5.75 / 6.75 / 6.25		7.25 / 6.75 / 6	7 / 7.25 / 6.75	5.75 / 6.75 / 6.5	6.75 / 7 / 6	7.25 / 6.25 / 7
Biometrics Login / WiFi / Bluetooth / Touchpad switches	✗ / ✗ / ✗ / ✗	✗ / ✗ / ✗ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✗ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✗ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗		✗ / ✗ / ✗ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗	✗ / ✓ / ✓ / ✗
Performance												
Synthetic Scores												
PC Mark 2005												
CPU / Memory Score	3937 / 3414	3872 / 2778	3310 / 2620	4123 / 3409	4190 / 3402	4632 / 3628		4606 / 3504	5353 / 4192	4663 / 3604	4628 / 3975	4721 / 3621
Graphics / HDD Score	1562 / 3841	574 / 4166	501 / 3636	1562 / 3626	1660 / 3693	1562 / 3563		1753 / 3979	1536 / 4146	1319 / 3643	1611 / 3373	2834 / 3823
Overall	3562	2537	2215	3526	3626	3728		3939	4102	3712	4088	4120
SiSoft Sandra X1 SP1												
CPU Arithmetic (Integer / Floating)	9438 / 5630	14245 / 10992	9203 / 5632	15623 / 10273	15282 / 10830	16474 / 11033		16976 / 11734	19283 / 14373	16937 / 11874	18234 / 15102	16985 / 11848
CPU Multimedia (Integer / Floating)	45393 / 24234	93283 / 42818	48282 / 25372	101383 / 48923	102202 / 49292	102537 / 54839		101112 / 54965	120393 / 65373	101038 / 53984	110239 / 57394	102395 / 54982
HDD Index	33	38	34	35	34	37		42	38	38	38	37
Memory bandwidth (Integer / Floating)	3142 / 3132	3523 / 3544	3425 / 3426	3173 / 3176	3192 / 3216	3498 / 3547		3337 / 3462	2034 / 2029	3292 / 3527	3627 / 3651	3273 / 3424
3D Mark 2005												
CPU / Overall Score	3722 / 472	3075 / 340	3527 / 340	4083 / 536	4102 / 561	3873 / 710		6591 / 1190	6012 / 694	3892 / 672	5162 / 620	4523 / 6423
Display Mate Tests												
DisplayMate Colour Accuracy Test (Avg, So 10)	5.75	5.75	5.75	5.75	6	5.5		5	6.75	5.5	6.5	6.25
Battery Life Test (Min)	91 min	81 min	97 min	87 min	98 min	102 min		93 min	101 min	98 min	103 min	129 min
WiFi Signal Strength Test	35%	32%	35%	38%	34%	41%		35%	37%	39%	34%	37%
Real World Tests												
Audio Test Speakers (So 10)	5	4.5	5.5	5	4.5	4.25		5	5	4	5.5	6.25
HD Movie Viewing (So 10)	4.5	5	4.5	6.25	5.5	5.5		5.5	6	4.25	6.5	6.25
Video Encoding (100 MB file) (Sec)	173.23	151.4	171.24	152.23	154.23	151.23		123.45	101.23	154.34	108.22	108.4
File transfer Test (1 GB assorted test file) (in MBps)	20.24 MBps	21.4 MBps	23.34 MBps	22.6 MBps	22.1 MBps	21.4 MBps		29.24 MBps	27.2 MBps	21.4 MBps	27.23 MBps	24.7 MBps
DOOM 3 (fps) (640x480, medium detail)	8.2	7.4	6.2	9.1	5.6	7.2		23.3	14.2	7.1	10.7	58.8
Far Cry (fps) (640x480, low detail)	23.27	27.33	17.24	21.5	15.42	26.23		31.3	36.34	22.34	37.26	92.52
Warranty (Years)	1 year	1 year	1 year	1 year	1 year	1 year		1 year	3 years	1 year	1 year	2 years



Sahara Imagebook 8WS

cheap, shockingly so for a notebook. If you must have a notebook for an unbelievably low price, this has got to be it.

Conclusion

Notebooks should ideally be oriented towards portability and performance / functionality in somewhat equal proportions. Bridging this set of requirements can be tricky, though not impossible. Dell manages this with their XPS M1330 rather well. ASUS does an excellent job with their U6SG—these notebooks well and truly bridge the divide. Just how bulky or powerful a notebook you want, or how important compactness is to you depends on your usage, and ultimately which parameter you’re willing to compromise on more. After all, you just can’t get a fast processor, 4 GB of RAM, 320 GB hard drive, and a 256 MB graphics solution on a small screen, not yet anyways. Technology has shrunk enough, however, that tiny marvels like the Vaio VGN-TZ37GN/R exist, and thrive. However at 11.1 inches, it may be a bit too compact for most, even those on the go.

A 15.4-inch form factor is too large a footprint for a portable machine. A screen size of 13.3 inches is more like what is acceptable, but we’re not giving up an ounce of processing power, or functionality. For those who desire something even more mobile we recommend a 12.1 inch notebook. With new ‘green’ hard drives that run cooler, faster and more efficient CPUs from Intel and AMD, and very watt-skimpy graphics solutions from ATI and NVIDIA, the whole shrink in screen size is a revolution that has arrived now...and not a distant vista we can drool over. ■

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